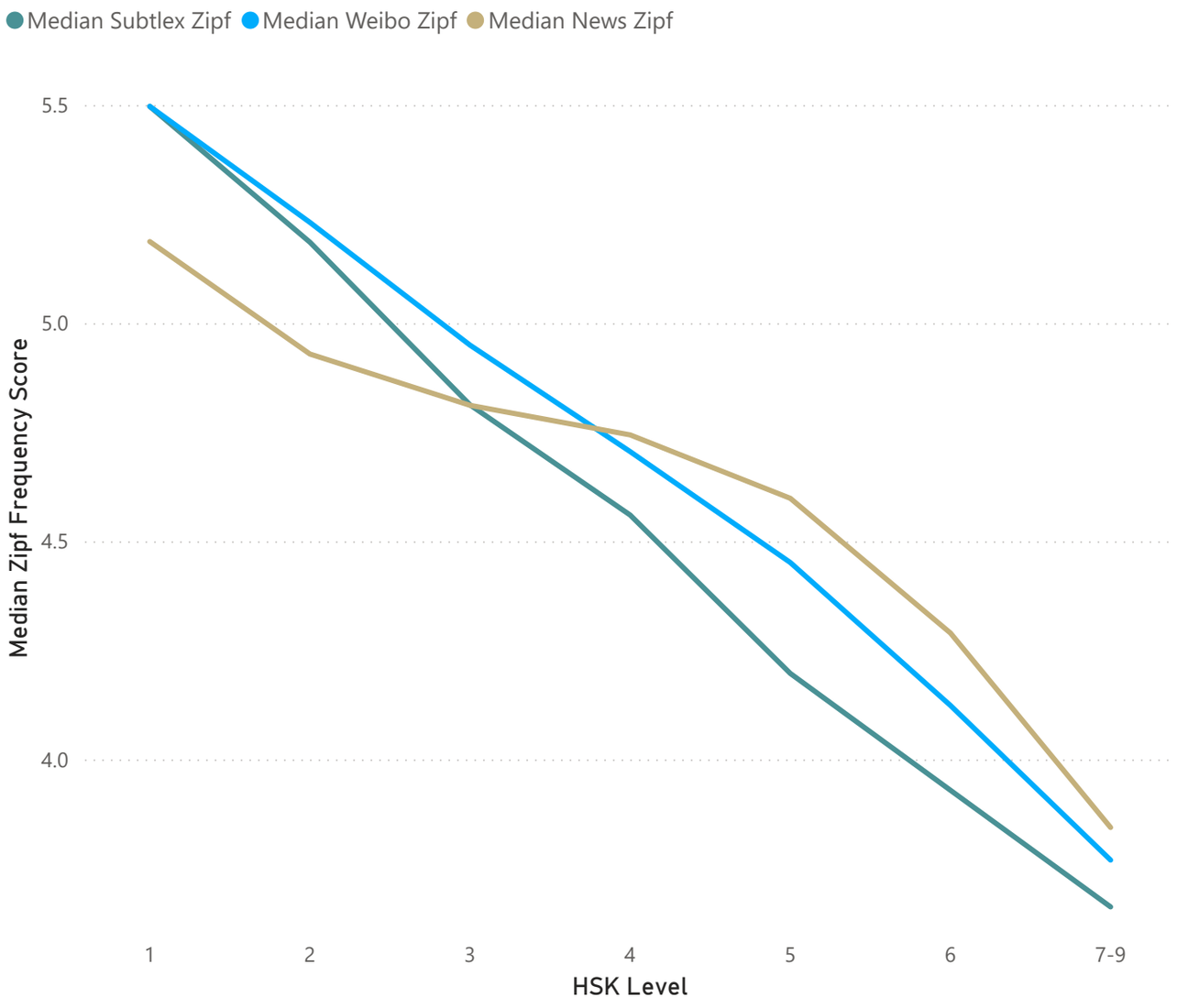
Chinese Curriculum Data Analytics: HSK 3.0 vs. Three Corpora

Median Zipf Frequency Trajectory by HSK Level (Reliable Words)



Incomplete Words Missing Across Corpora

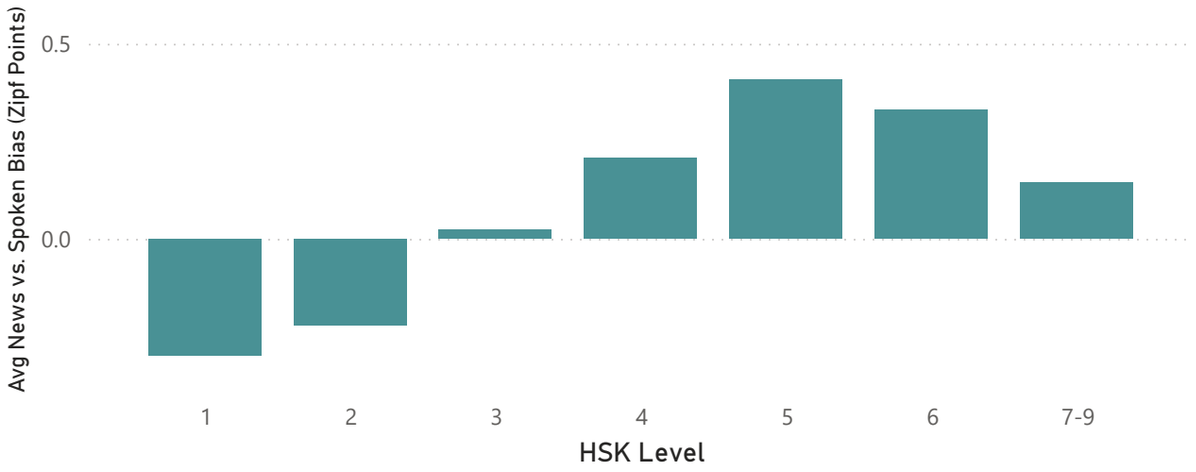
Word	HSK Level	Missing From
黑客	7-9	Weibo, News
鹏程万里	7-9	Subtlex
高铁	3	Subtlex
首批	7-9	Subtlex
首付	7-9	Subtlex, Weibo, News
飙升	7-9	Weibo, News
风景线	7-9	Weibo, News
领军	7-9	Subtlex, Weibo, News
顺其自然	7-9	Subtlex
顶级	7-9	Weibo, News
面条儿	1	Subtlex, Weibo, News
面前	3	Weibo, News
零	1	Weibo, News
难得一见	7-9	Subtlex, Weibo, News
随着	4	Weibo, News
防汛	7-9	Subtlex, Weibo, News
门口	2	Weibo, News
长期以来	7-9	Weibo, News
长效	7-9	Weibo, News
链接	6	Subtlex
银行卡	3	Subtlex, Weibo, News
重中之重	7-9	Weibo, News

HSK Level

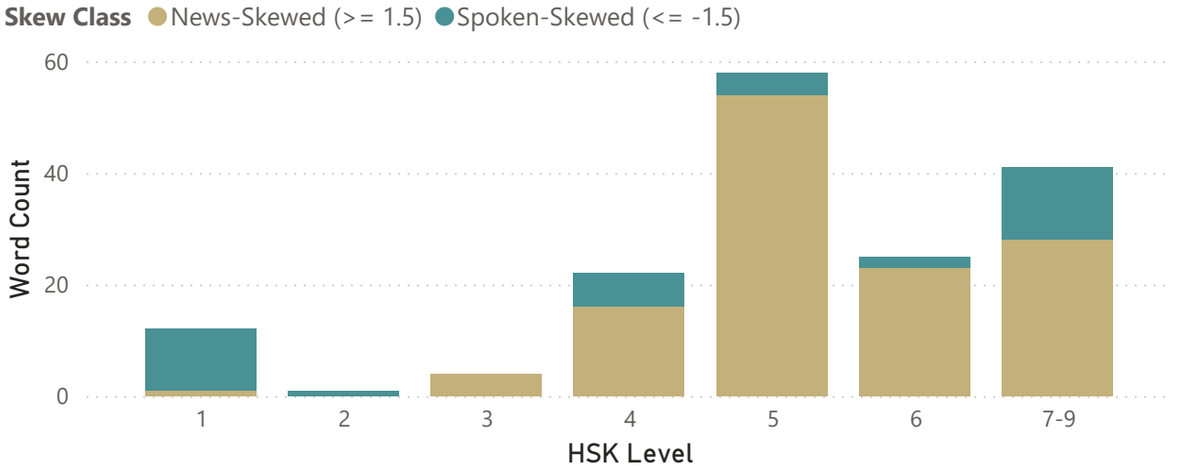
All

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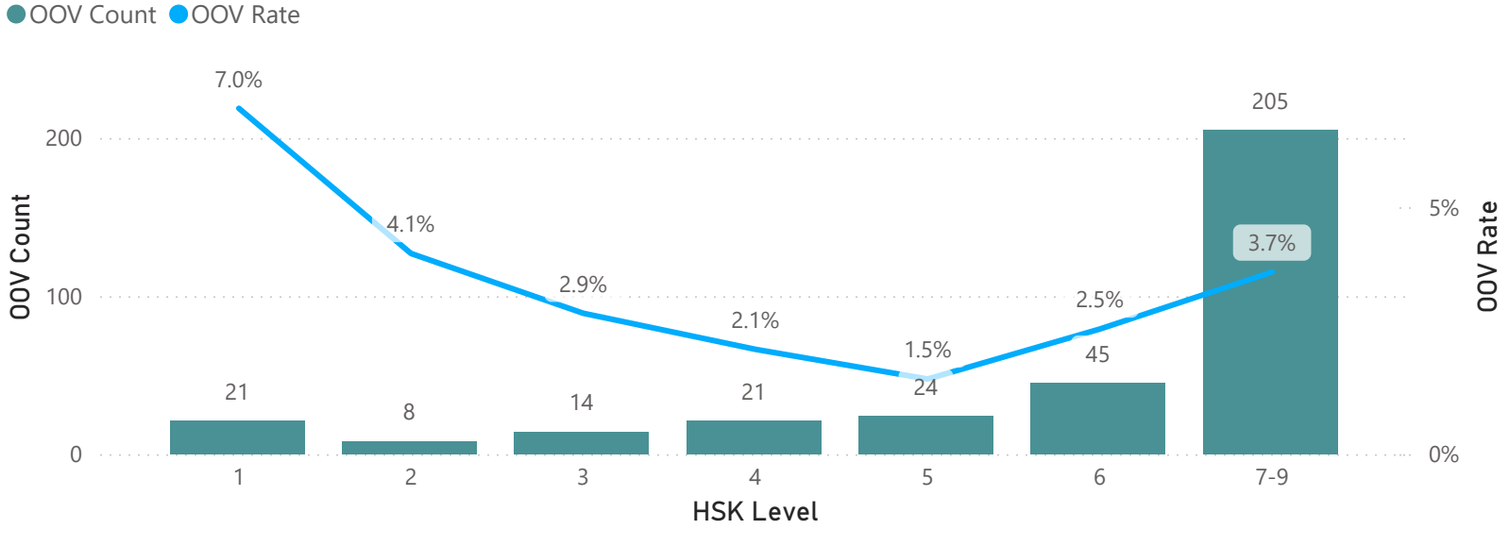
Average News vs. Spoken Bias by HSK Level (Reliable Words)



Skew Class Distribution Across HSK Levels (Reliable Words)



OOV Word Count and OOV Rate by HSK Level

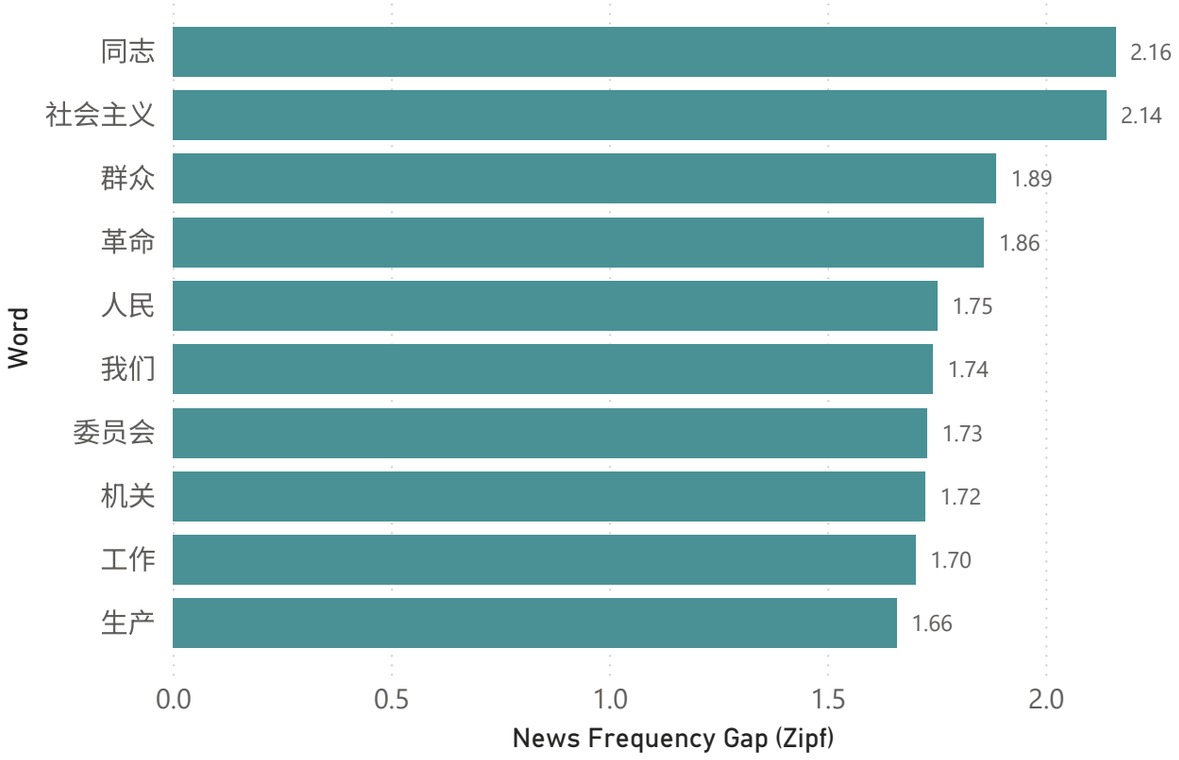


High-Frequency News Words Not in the HSK 3.0 List

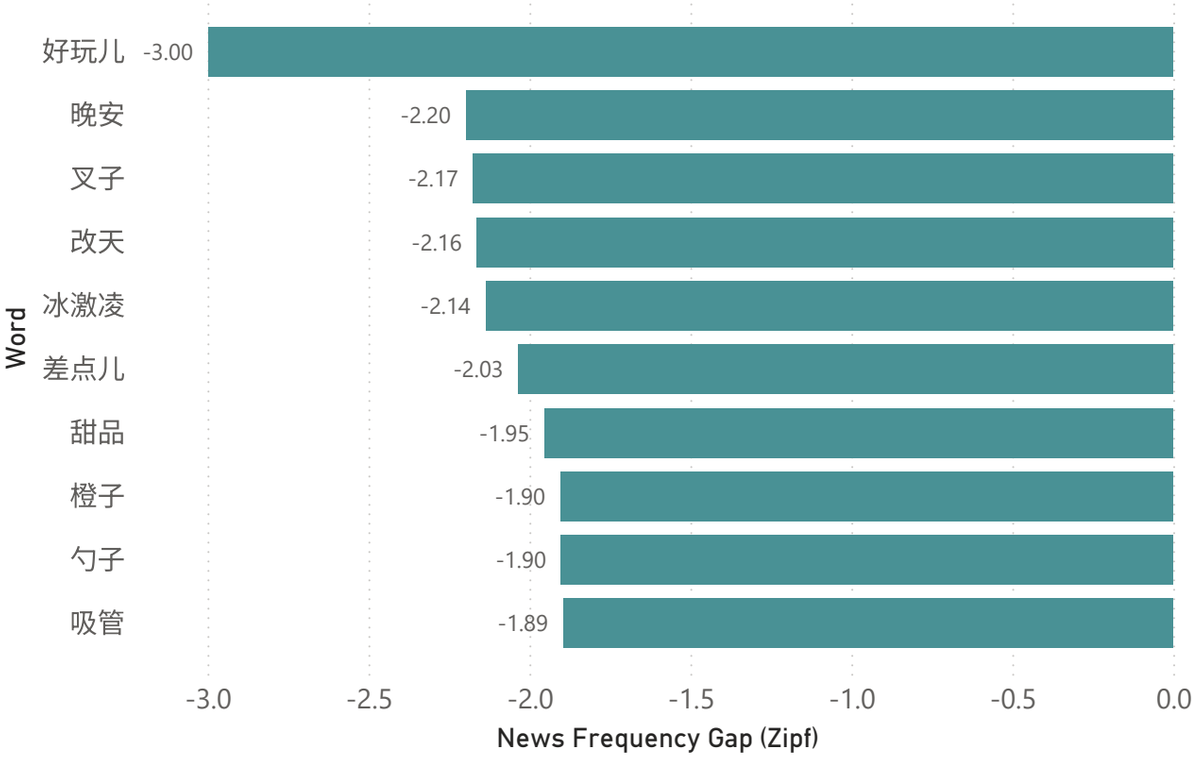
Word	News Count	Zipf News	Zipf Subtlex	Zipf Weibo
美国	1,676,394.00	6.04	5.56	5.40
全国	1,371,641.00	5.95	4.54	5.05
毛主席	1,345,612.00	5.94		4.13
我国	1,143,295.00	5.87	3.69	4.59
新华社	1,097,866.00	5.86	1.78	3.89
本报讯	1,072,841.00	5.84		3.57
这种	1,040,610.00	5.83	5.64	5.61
北京	993,577.00	5.81	3.62	5.44
不能	912,692.00	5.77	5.43	5.86

Chinese Curriculum Data Analytics: HSK 3.0 vs. Three Corpora

Top 10 Words Over-Represented in News (Positive Gap)



Top 10 Words Under-Represented in News (Negative Gap)



HSK Corpus Data Analytics: Methodology & Limitations

PURPOSE: Does the HSK 3.0 level grading match how often words are used, and does the answer change by register?

SOURCES:

- HSK 3.0 word list, July 2026 syllabus (10,896 words after merging sense variants such as 花2 into 花).
- SUBTLEX-CH: film/TV subtitles, 2010, about 33.5M words. Scripted dialogue, used as a proxy for spoken language.
- BCC Weibo (about 4.3B tokens) and BCC News (about 1.5B tokens) word lists. The News list appears to be official-press text (本报讯 and 新华社 are among its most frequent non-HSK words).

DEFINITIONS:

- Zipf = log10(frequency per million) + 3. Each +1 means ten times more frequent.
- Bias = Zipf News - Zipf Subtlex/Spoken. Positive means the word leans toward News.
- Complete words are present in all three lists (10,558). Reliable words are complete with at least 50 occurrences in every list (8,165).
- Median lines, average bias and skew classes use reliable words. The OOV chart and the incomplete-words table use all words.
- Skew classes: News-skewed (bias >= 1.5), Spoken-skewed (<= -1.5).
- Gap (page 3): a word's News Zipf minus the median News Zipf of its HSK level.

FINDINGS:

Levels 1-2 lean spoken and Levels 4-6 lean toward News at every minimum-count threshold tested. The Level 7-9 News lean depends on the threshold (average bias 0.44 for all complete words, 0.14 at a minimum count of 50, about 0 at 100).

LIMITATIONS:

- The subtitle corpus is small and from 2010, so rare-word counts are noisy and modern vocabulary is missing.
- OOV means "not a token in that list", not "unused". Causes include numerals missing from the BCC lists, compounds split by the segmenter, modern terms missing from 2010 subtitles, and erhua forms such as 面条儿 written without 儿 in the corpora.
- Single-character words are distorted by differing segmentation.
- The cutoffs (bias of 1.5, count of 50) are analyst choices.
- "Not in the HSK list" means absent from the 11,000-word list. Proper names may be listed separately. Blank cells in the table mean the word is not in that list.